

When Words Stop Working. *Point instead.*

Communication boards and de-escalation, TK through grade 12. During escalation a student cannot get words out and cannot take words in. A board is the one channel that stays open.

IN THE MOMENT: THREE THINGS THAT WORK

1

Stop talking.

Three words or fewer. Explaining, reasoning, and restating the rule all add load a student can no longer process.

2

Model, don't demand.

Point to the words while you speak. Never say "use your board." That turns a support into one more thing to fail at.

3

Say yes.

Honor the request every time. A board honored four times out of five teaches that behavior is the more reliable option.

Boards work during agitation and acceleration, and again in recovery. At peak, nothing does. Expect that, or staff will abandon the tool.

THE BOARD ANY CLASSROOM CAN USE

Organize by row, and say the rows out loud.

Row 1 refuses. Row 2 asks. Row 3 explains. A teacher who knows that finds a word in two seconds. A student who knows it navigates by position instead of scanning.

TK to 2 stop, no, help / break, all done, my turn / mad, too loud, hurt

3 to 5 stop, no, later, leave me alone / break, I need space, help, walk with me / mad, frustrated, too loud, too hard

6 to 12 I need a minute, Not right now, Please back off / I need to step out, I need help, Go get _____ / I can't answer yet, Too much noise in here, I'll talk about it after

Most cells refuse or request. Only the bottom row names a feeling. A student in acceleration needs to say "back off" legally, not label an emotion.

IF THE STUDENT HAS A DEVICE

Keep it in their hands.

Removing a device during behavior removes the student's voice. We wouldn't ask a speaking student to leave theirs in a backpack.

On Proloquo2Go Intermediate Core at 60 buttons, row four does the whole job:



Row 4, columns 1 to 4. One hit each.

The Feelings folder labels fourteen emotions and cannot refuse, request, or exit. Go to Home first, then Feelings only to explain.



Scan with your phone camera **for the printable boards, staff scripts, and the device guide.**

Or visit jbutanda.github.io/RUSD-AAC-HUB/deescalation-boards.html

Teach it on a calm day. Honor it every time.

Print, share, keep close. Bring your questions.